

CS 377 Syllabus

Ethical Issues in Computing · University of Illinois Chicago

[HTML version](#) [Course site](#)

Course Details

Instructor: Jack Bandy (jxb@uic.edu)

Course site: doethics.fun

Course description: Communication skills for computing professionals, including presentation organization, visual aids, delivery techniques, and argument support. Ethical and societal issues in computing include privacy, intellectual property and ownership, and crime.

Prerequisite: Credit or concurrent registration in CS 251.

The current meeting times, room, office hours, teaching assistants, assignment deadlines, and grades are listed in Canvas.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- explain professional responsibilities related to ethical, legal, security, and social issues in computing;
- analyze current events using virtue ethics, deontological ethics, utilitarian ethics, and care ethics;
- identify recurring ethical challenges in the design and use of computing systems; and
- communicate ethical analysis clearly to technical and nontechnical audiences.

Course Materials

Core readings will be provided through Canvas, printed copies, web archives, or linked PDFs. There is no required textbook. The course draws from *Computing and Technology Ethics: Engaging through Science Fiction* by Emanuelle Burton, Judy Goldsmith, Nicholas Mattei, Cory Siler, and Sara-Jo Swiatek.

Students need a web browser that can access Canvas and the course website.

Assessment

Category	Weight
Out-of-class exercises	20%
Read a Book project	20%
In-class group exercises	20%
Pre-class reflections	20%
Attendance, participation, and civility	20%

Final grades use the following scale: A = 90–100%, B = 80–89%, C = 70–79%, D = 60–69%, and F = below 60%.

Attendance and Participation

Showing up makes a substantial difference in this course. Class meetings are designed around discussion and group work, so students should attend, arrive on time, and participate. Notify the instructor as soon as possible when illness, personal emergencies, university obligations, religious observances, or other circumstances prevent attendance.

Three absences may be taken without penalty. Students who miss more than half of all class sessions will not be able to pass the course. Make-up instructions for missed in-class exercises will be provided when appropriate.

Late Work

Due dates are listed in Canvas. Out-of-class exercises and pre-class reflections may not be accepted more than one week after the deadline. Contact the instructor before a deadline when possible; flexibility is easier to provide in advance.

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to follow UIC's [Community Standards](#) and policies on [academic integrity](#). Protect the copyright integrity of course materials, especially materials distributed through Canvas.

Accommodations

UIC is committed to full inclusion and participation of people with disabilities. Students who face or anticipate disability-related barriers should contact the [Disability Resource Center](#) at drc@uic.edu or (312) 413-2183. Upon receipt of a Letter of Accommodation, the instructor will work with the student and DRC to implement approved accommodations.

Students seeking religious accommodations should notify the instructor by the tenth day of the semester, or at least five days in advance when the observance occurs earlier.

Classroom Community

Every member of the class is expected to contribute to a respectful, welcoming, and inclusive environment. Assume goodwill, listen carefully, debate ideas rather than people, respect privacy, and remain open to revising your position.

Some course materials address war, discrimination, surveillance, violence, and other difficult subjects. These topics will be discussed with dignity, humanity, rigor, and respect for scholarly inquiry.

Schedule

The detailed and most current schedule is published on the [course homepage](#). The instructor may revise readings, activities, or deadlines as course needs develop; changes will be announced in class and through Canvas.